

Anti-Fraud, Bribery, Corruption and Whistleblowing

Protecting the funds entrusted to us, and protecting those who speak up

Policy owner	CHIEF OPERATIONS OFFICER	Approved by	Board of Trustees
Version	1.0	Date adopted	05/08/2026
Applies to	All trustees, staff, volunteers, consultants, contractors, suppliers and partner personnel		
Read with	Conflict of Interest Policy; Code of Conduct; financial controls and procurement procedures		

1. Statement

- 1.1** Every naira entrusted to Synia Aid Foundation belongs to the people we serve. We have **zero tolerance** of fraud, bribery, corruption and theft, whoever commits them and whatever their seniority.
- 1.2** We will investigate every credible allegation, pursue recovery, apply disciplinary sanction, and refer criminal conduct to the authorities.

2. Definitions

- 2.1** **Fraud** is any intentional deception made for personal or third-party gain, or to cause loss to another — including false claims, falsified records, ghost beneficiaries, inflated invoices and misreported results.
- 2.2** **Bribery** is offering, giving, requesting or accepting any financial or other advantage to induce or reward improper performance.
- 2.3** **Corruption** is the misuse of entrusted power for private gain, including nepotism, favouritism and the diversion of assistance.
- 2.4** **Facilitation payments** are small unofficial payments to secure or speed a routine action. **They are prohibited without exception**, notwithstanding local practice.
- 2.5** The Foundation is a Designated Non-Financial Institution under Nigerian anti-money-laundering law and complies with the reporting obligations that follow from that status.

3. Prohibited conduct

EXAMPLES — NOT AN EXHAUSTIVE LIST

- Taking or diverting cash, goods, fuel, equipment or supplies intended for the people we serve.
- Creating false or duplicate beneficiaries, or signing distribution lists for people who did not receive anything.
- Requesting or accepting payment, a gift or a favour in exchange for selection onto a programme.
- Colluding with a supplier, inflating a quotation, or splitting a purchase to avoid an authorisation threshold.
- Awarding work to a relative, associate or connected business without declaration and open process.
- Falsifying receipts, timesheets, attendance registers, monitoring data or reports to donors.
- Using Foundation funds, vehicles, premises or name for private benefit.
- Offering or accepting any payment to influence an official decision.

4. Prevention

- 4.1** **Segregation of duties.** No individual may initiate, approve, execute and record the same transaction. In particular, no person both selects a participant and releases their grant, asset or benefit.
- 4.2** **Authorisation.** All expenditure is approved in advance within the Board-approved budget, at the thresholds set at clause 6.2.
- 4.3** **Procurement.** Purchases above the threshold at clause 6.2 require written quotations from at least three suppliers, with the specifier and the purchaser being different people.
- 4.4** **Disbursement.** Grants to participants are released in stages against recorded milestones, never as a single unverified lump sum.
- 4.5** **Records.** Signed distribution lists, receipts and delivery records are retained for every item issued.
- 4.6** **Review.** Management accounts are reviewed monthly against budget, and annually by an independent auditor.

5. Whistleblowing — raising a concern

- 5.1** **Anyone may raise a concern** — trustees, staff, volunteers, participants, community members, suppliers, partners or members of the public.
- 5.2** Concerns are raised confidentially to INFO@SYNIAFOUNDATION.ORG. Where the concern involves that person, the Founder-Chair or the Chief Operations Officer, it is raised with the nominated independent Trustee at NASBELLA@GMAIL.COM.

- 5.3 Concerns may be raised anonymously. An anonymous report will still be investigated, though this may limit how fully we can pursue it.
- 5.4 **Everyone covered by this policy has a duty to report** any suspicion of fraud, bribery or corruption. Failing to do so is itself a disciplinary matter.

PROTECTION FOR WHISTLEBLOWERS

- No person who raises a concern in good faith will be dismissed, disciplined, demoted, excluded from a programme or disadvantaged in any way.
- This protection applies **even if the concern turns out to be mistaken**. You are not required to be right, or to hold proof.
- Retaliation against a whistleblower is itself gross misconduct.
- Your identity will not be disclosed without your consent, except where the law requires it.
- Only a knowingly false or malicious allegation is a disciplinary matter.

- 5.5 If a concern is not addressed, or the matter concerns the Board itself, it may be raised externally — with the Economic and Financial Crimes Commission, the Corporate Affairs Commission, the Nigeria Police Force, or a funder of the affected programme.

6. Response and thresholds

- 6.1 Every report is acknowledged within five working days, recorded, and assessed. Where there is a credible risk of continuing loss, immediate protective measures are taken including suspension of the individual and of the payment route concerned.
- 6.2 **Financial thresholds** are set by the Board on adoption of this policy:

CONTROL	APPLIES ABOVE
Expenditure requiring dual authorisation	₦ 100,000.00
Procurement requiring three written quotations	₦ 100,000.00
Expenditure requiring prior Board approval	₦ 100,000.00

- 6.3 Investigation is conducted promptly by someone independent of the matter, and may be escalated to an external investigator where the amount or seniority involved requires it.
- 6.4 Substantiated fraud results in dismissal or termination, recovery of losses, and referral to the appropriate authority. The Board is notified of every allegation within seventy-two hours.
- 6.5 Where donor funds are affected, the relevant funder is informed promptly and in accordance with the terms of the grant.

7. Gifts and hospitality

- 7.1 No gift, hospitality or benefit may be accepted where it could reasonably be seen to influence a decision, or be offered in return for support the Foundation provides.
- 7.2 Modest hospitality in the ordinary course of business may be accepted, and must be declared where its value exceeds the limit set by the Board on adoption: ₦ 1,000.00
- 7.3 All declarable gifts and hospitality are recorded in the register maintained under the Conflict of Interest Policy.